

DRAMA

OVERVIEW

At the Grade 11 and 12 level, drama students extend their understanding and interpretation of dramatic texts, forms, characters, and theatrical productions. They incorporate a variety of dramatic elements and conventions in their performances and productions. Students engage in increasingly effective social interactions and collaboration as they create, perform, and analyse drama. In these courses, students will experience being performer, audience, playwright, technician, designer, and critic.

Students use the elements of drama (role/character, relationship, time and place, focus and emphasis, and tension) to create works that are related to their personal interest and experience. In doing so, they integrate technology to enhance the impact of drama works and to help convey mood, create tension, and communicate a message.

Students examine how different styles and traditions of drama can affect social and cultural conditions in a variety of Canadian and global contexts. Students explore various opportunities for careers in drama and other arts while developing skills that can be linked to a range of careers. They enhance their ability to analyse and interpret a range of drama work, and reflect on and evaluate their own and others' creative work.

The expectations for drama courses are organized in three distinct but related strands:

1. ***Creating and Presenting:*** Students use the creative process (see pages 15–17) to develop, produce, and perform drama. Students interpret dramatic texts and use appropriate dramatic forms, elements, techniques, and technologies to present their ideas and achieve specific purposes. In all creative projects, students will develop and present their work both individually and in ensemble.
2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** In this strand, students use the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) to identify and reflect on their response to dramatic works and develop their understanding of how dramatic purpose is achieved. Students explore how societies present and past use or have used drama, and they reflect on ways in which drama can lead to a deeper understanding of themselves and the communities in which they live. Students are challenged to examine their artistic choices and processes and to determine what they have learned from them.
3. ***Foundations:*** This strand addresses dramatic forms, conventions, practices, and skills. Students refine their knowledge of theoretical concepts through active engagement in drama. They deepen their understanding of the origins and development of drama and theatre arts and their influence on past and present societies. They communicate by using terminology specific to creating, presenting, and analysing drama. Students continue to study the significance of health and safety issues as well as a variety of protocols related to ethics and etiquette in drama activities.

For policy guidelines pertaining to focus courses, see pages 12–13 of this document.
The list of approved focus courses for Drama can be found at:
www.edu.gov.on.ca/eng/curriculum/secondary/arts.html.

Drama, Grade 12

Workplace Preparation

ADA4E

This course requires students to create, present, and analyse a variety of dramatic works relevant to the workplace. Students will build trust and collaborative skills and develop self-confidence through hands-on experience and project-based learning in drama activities. Students will also explore skills related to the study of drama that can be applied in the workplace.

Prerequisite: Drama, Grade 11, Open

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** use the creative process and a variety of sources and forms, both individually and collaboratively, to design and develop drama works;
- A2. Elements and Conventions:** use the elements and conventions of drama effectively in creating individual and ensemble works, including works based on a variety of sources;
- A3. Presentation Techniques and Technologies:** use a variety of presentation techniques and technological tools to enhance the impact of drama works and communicate for specific audiences and purposes.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use a variety of sources as a basis for creating scenes about workplace issues (*e.g., use ideas from books about “how to complain” or “dealing with difficult people” to dramatize the handling of a client grievance; use a newspaper story about an equity or human rights issue as the basis for a courtroom drama*)

Teacher prompt: “What different characters could you include in a skit about a human rights enquiry?”

- A1.2** choose appropriate drama forms to explore a variety of perspectives on the world of work and business (*e.g., use a sitcom format to explore a particular working environment such as a restaurant kitchen or a law office; use monologue or dialogue formats to dramatize the perspectives of employees and/or employers on a workplace issue*)

Teacher prompt: “How could you dramatize the different reactions of an employee and an employer to an attempt to unionize the work force?”

- A1.3** create a scene or sequence of scenes featuring a character who demonstrates employability skills (*e.g., scenes illustrating the job application and interview process, including the depiction of a range of emotional states experienced by the*

applicant, such as excitement, anxiety, confidence; scenes modelling appropriate behaviours for a variety of workplace roles)

Teacher prompt: “What are some of the qualities you might look for when interviewing someone for a job in the arts?”

A2. Elements and Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

- A2.1** combine and arrange the elements of drama to create scenes that explore common workplace roles and situations (*e.g., use a focus on equity in a drama about interviewing applicants for a position; use a shop-floor setting in a drama about safe work habits*)

Teacher prompt: “What kinds of equity issues should job applicants and job recruiters be aware of? How could you develop a drama that shows the issues from both points of view?”

- A2.2** use a variety of drama conventions to interpret roles and issues in the workplace (*e.g., use voices in the head and role on the wall to explore the multi-faceted responsibilities of an employee in a retail or service setting; use flashbacks to an earlier job to explain the behaviour of a supervisor or manager*)

Teacher prompt: “How might the supervisor’s previous experience in entry-level jobs influence her attitude to the workers who report to her?”

A3. Presentation Techniques and Technologies

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 use a variety of techniques to engage specific workplace audiences for various purposes (*e.g., use questioning to engage an audience of trainees in a presentation about workplace safety; use a demonstration such as a make-up application as part of a sales pitch for a product*)

Teacher prompt: “How might audio of accident noises strengthen your presentation on safe work habits?”

A3.2 use various drama techniques to enhance workplace presentations (*e.g., use blocking to visualize and plan the layout and audience traffic patterns for a product display; plan and rehearse*

phrasing, pauses, vocal inflection and emphasis, gestures, and eye contact to enhance delivery of a seminar or sales presentation)

Teacher prompts: “Which memorization techniques will you use to prepare for your seminar?” “How might relaxation exercises help you prepare for an interview or audition?”

A3.3 select and use a variety of technological tools, including forms of new media, to enhance workplace presentations (*e.g., use an overhead projector, visuals, and audio recordings to support a promotion of a new product; use a webcam to create a training video for trainees to access through the Internet*)

Teacher prompt: “What visual aids can you use to illustrate the steps in your presentation?”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** use the critical analysis process to reflect on and evaluate their own and others' drama works;
- B2. Drama and Society:** demonstrate an understanding of how societies present and past use or have used drama, and of how creating and viewing drama can benefit individuals, groups, and communities;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** identify knowledge and skills they have acquired through drama activities, and demonstrate an understanding of ways in which they can apply this learning in personal, social, and career contexts.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** use the critical analysis process to determine the responsibilities attached to different roles within the group and to guide and monitor progress (*e.g., use self- and peer-assessment strategies to identify personal strengths and areas for improvement; complete teacher-guided reflections to monitor and fine-tune roles during the rehearsal process*)

Teacher prompt: "What role(s) will you take on in this collaborative assignment? Why did you choose this role? What responsibilities will each group member have?"

- B1.2** analyse presentations about workplace topics to determine how accurately they depict workplace realities (*e.g., analyse the depiction of workplace conditions and issues in a film, a television show, or a stage work by their classmates and compare it to information acquired from real-world work experiences, community service, or career research*)

Teacher prompts: "What real-world workplace settings are you familiar with? What workplace issues are you aware of from your own experience? From films and TV shows? Do you think films and TV shows are useful sources of information about workplace issues and behaviour?" "Why is it important to explore difficult issues

and represent them through drama? What can be gained by both actors and audience from this experience?"

- B1.3** explain ways in which drama activities develop their ability to determine the accuracy and effectiveness of media representations (*e.g., creating and viewing drama can enhance awareness of the purposes and creative choices that shape media works*)

Teacher prompt: "Was the difficulty of the job exaggerated in this presentation? Or was it oversimplified? Why do you think it was treated in this way? What message did this treatment send to the viewer?"

B2. Drama and Society

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** demonstrate an understanding of how knowledge and skills developed through drama can be used in social and workplace contexts (*e.g., visualization skills developed through role playing can help in preparing for new social situations or in training exercises; creative and performance skills can enhance the design and delivery of marketing and product information presentations*)

Teacher prompts: "How might your ability to choose appropriate costumes for a drama help you in a social or workplace context?" "What are some similarities between performing a role on stage and 'performing the role' of a job?"

B2.2 identify ways in which drama activities strengthen their social and employability skills (e.g., by emphasizing skills and attitudes such as punctuality, acceptance of responsibility, ability to take direction, respect for others)

Teacher prompt: “What are the characteristics of a ‘professional attitude’? What can you learn or have you learned about professional behaviour from your drama activities? Are these skills and attitudes relevant only in employment contexts?”

B2.3 explain how drama activities provide insight into different types of roles, social or occupational hierarchies, and issues they may encounter in the workplace (e.g., viewing drama works provides a range of perspectives on social interaction, power relationships, and ethical issues in social and occupational contexts; ensemble drama work provides experience of roles and responsibilities in product development and project management processes)

Teacher prompts: “How would you describe the employer–employee–client relationships depicted in this scene? Are they believable? Or are they too stereotypical or idealized? Give reasons to support your opinion.” “What is the importance of having a leader on a project? What are the difficulties of having no leader, or more than one?”

B2.4 describe ways in which dramas or other works that use elements of drama can reflect the culture and experience of work (e.g., the musical *A Chorus Line* reveals and critiques the reality of the lives of stage performers; *Dan Needles’s Wingfield Trilogy* explores farm life in Canada using humour; *Michael Moore’s documentaries Roger and Me* and *Sicko* explore and critique the tensions between economics and ethics in the automotive and health care industries)

Teacher prompt: “How could we use drama to challenge the dominance of cliques in the school and strengthen awareness of our common interests?”

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 explain how the strategies for conflict resolution and team building used in drama can be applied in the workplace (e.g., collaborative processes such as forum theatre, voices in the head, or corridor of voices can be used to assist in group problem solving and/or conflict resolution)

Teacher prompts: “What common types of conflicts arise in the workplace? How could you use the skills you have learned in drama to help solve such conflicts?” “How can our new understandings about group theatre and shared leadership be applied in a workplace setting?”

B3.2 identify personal strategies and skills they have developed through drama activities and explain how they can contribute to success in workplace contexts (e.g., the ability to interpret verbal and non-verbal cues such as tone of voice and body language can help them understand others and communicate effectively in a wide range of situations)

Teacher prompt: “How could you use verbal cues and body language to suggest changes in a persuasive, non-threatening manner?”

B3.3 identify and describe employment opportunities and careers in the theatre industry, and describe the competencies they require (e.g., outline the responsibilities of different types of theatre workers, such as actor, backstage technician, front-of-house staff, custodial staff, arts administrator)

Teacher prompt: “What skills and preparation would you need for these workplace roles? How have your classroom drama activities equipped you for some or all of these roles?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Concepts and Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of the nature and functions of drama forms, elements, conventions, and techniques, including the correct terminology for the various components;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the origins and development of drama and theatre arts and their influence on past and present societies;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of safe, ethical, and responsible personal and interpersonal practices in drama activities.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Concepts and Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify a variety of forms, elements, conventions, and techniques of drama and describe some of their functions (*e.g., how situation comedy can be used to critique foolish or pretentious behaviour; how character can be used to illustrate a theme; how physical place and historical time period can be used to clarify motivation; how gesture and voice can be used to reveal a character's attitudes and emotions; how blocking can be used to help create tension*)

Teacher prompt: "How is mime used to dramatize the impact of mass production methods on workers in Charlie Chaplin's *Modern Times*? Why is it so effective?"

- C1.2** use correct terminology for the styles, components, processes, and techniques of drama in creating and responding to drama works (*e.g., voices in the head, thought tracking, accepting offers, advancing a scene, improvisation*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some ways of 'advancing a scene' when improvising with a partner (*e.g., adding a new detail, continuing the game, raising the stakes, connecting unrelated details, beginning to carry out an anticipated action, disrupting a routine*)?"

- C1.3** demonstrate an understanding of the nature and purpose of informational and support materials for drama productions (*e.g., rehearsal schedules, prompt scripts, blocking diagrams,*

cue sheets for lighting and special effects, brochures, programs, promotion schedules, press releases, commercials)

Teacher prompt: "What information should be included on an advertising poster for the performance of a play?"

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe how social and cultural patterns influence the forms and subject matter of drama (*e.g., connect character types from commedia dell'arte to social conditions in sixteenth-century Italy; compare depictions of women's roles in Restoration and nineteenth-century dramas and give reasons for the differences; explain how themes and characters in the drama of Western societies changed to reflect the growth of industrialization and urbanization; explain the social background to themes of migration in the drama of diverse cultures*)

Teacher prompt: "What are some common themes in Canadian drama? What social or cultural realities do they reflect?"

- C2.2** suggest ways in which current media forms and technologies influence the content and presentation of drama works (*e.g., the role of electronic technologies in daily life is a theme in contemporary drama – including the "dramas" depicted in advertisements; webcams, webcasts, and video technology provide access to global audiences for both amateur and professional*

drama creators; video and audio technology are used to add special effects to film and stage productions)

Teacher prompt: “How are video games similar to or different from action-adventure films? How have developments in video games been adapted for some types of film and television dramas?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and follow safe and ethical practices in drama activities and explain their relevance to workplace settings (*e.g., explain the relevance of Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System [WHMIS] labelling to theatre and other workplace settings; identify safety training and certifications that are relevant to occupations in the theatre and other fields; identify and follow procedures for the environmentally responsible use of materials and energy; explain the importance of developing and implementing workplace antiharassment and antidiscrimination policies and guidelines*)

Teacher prompts: “What safety concerns have you become aware of through your work in drama? How does safety training prepare you for other types of jobs?” “What steps can people take to prevent or combat harassment in their workplace?”

C3.2 demonstrate an understanding of tasks and responsibilities in producing drama works that have counterparts in other workplace settings (*e.g., preparing progress reports for colleagues; participating in team meetings; being punctual and keeping to timelines; complying with codes of conduct; clarifying and fulfilling job expectations*)

Teacher prompt: “How do we ensure that all team members fulfil their responsibilities to the project?”

C3.3 demonstrate an understanding of correct theatre worker and audience etiquette and its relevance to other workplace contexts (*e.g., use appropriate professional language; observe dress codes; demonstrate appropriate conduct in meetings*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the appropriate style of dress for this particular role?” “How might you have to change your everyday behaviour to suit a particular workplace role or environment?”